Product Requirements Document (PRD) – ScrollControl

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1. Product Overview

Product Name: ScrollControl

ScrollControl is a mobile-first productivity application designed to help users reduce excessive scrolling behavior by providing real-time awareness, gentle interruptions, and focus tools.

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2. Problem Statement

Many users spend significant time on social media and other apps without realizing how long they have been scrolling. This leads to:

- Reduced productivity
- Loss of focus during study/work sessions
- Increased mental fatigue
- Poor time management

Existing solutions either:

- Only track usage (passive), or
- Aggressively block apps (frustrating)

There is a need for a **balanced solution** that helps users regain control without being intrusive.

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3. Objectives

- Help users **become aware of their scrolling habits**
- Reduce unnecessary screen time
- Encourage intentional usage of apps
- Improve focus during work/study sessions

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4. Target Users

Primary Users

- University students
- Individuals preparing for exams
- People struggling with distractions

Secondary Users

- Remote workers
- General smartphone users seeking better productivity

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5. Value Proposition

ScrollControl helps users take control of their screen time by:

- Detecting prolonged scrolling
- Providing timely, gentle interruptions
- Offering tools to refocus instantly

Unlike traditional blockers, ScrollControl focuses on **awareness and behavior change**, not force.

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6. Key Features (MVP)

6.1 Focus Timer

- Start/stop focus sessions
- Default duration (e.g., 25 minutes)
- Runs in background

6.2 App Usage Tracking (Android)

- Tracks time spent on selected apps
- Displays daily usage summary

6.3 Smart Interrupt (Core Feature)

- Detects continuous app usage beyond a threshold
- Sends a notification:

    - “You’ve been scrolling for X minutes”
- Provides quick actions:
    - Continue
    - Start focus session

6.4 Daily Insights

- Total screen time
- Most used apps
- Focus time completed

6.5 Permission Transparency

- Clear explanation before requesting permissions
- User can enable/disable tracking anytime

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7. User Experience Principles

- **Minimal**: No clutter, only essential features
- **Fast**: Actions completed in 1–2 taps
- **Non-intrusive**: Gentle reminders, not aggressive blocking
- **Clear**: Users always understand what the app is doing

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8. User Journey

Primary Flow

1. User opens ScrollControl
2. Starts a focus session
3. Leaves app
4. Begins scrolling on another app
5. ScrollControl detects usage
6. Sends a reminder

7. User chooses to:
    - Continue scrolling
    - Refocus

Secondary Flow

- User opens app to check stats
- Gains insight into usage patterns
- Adjusts behavior over time

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9. Success Metrics

- Daily active users (DAU)
- Average focus time per user
- Reduction in screen time
- Number of interruptions leading to refocus
- User retention (7-day and 30-day)

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10. Constraints & Assumptions

Constraints

- Limited tracking capabilities on iOS
- Strict app store policies on permissions
- Must ensure privacy compliance

Assumptions

- Users are willing to grant usage permissions
- Users prefer guidance over strict blocking
- Simplicity improves adoption

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11. Platform Strategy

Android (Primary Platform)

- Full feature set:
    - Usage tracking
    - Smart interrupt
    - Focus tools

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iOS (Limited Version)

- Focus timer
- Manual tracking
- Notifications

Web (Support Platform)

- Dashboard (future)
- Analytics and insights

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12. Future Enhancements

- Smarter interruption logic (behavior-based)
- Weekly reports and trends
- Gamification (streaks, achievements)
- Social accountability features
- Web dashboard integration

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13. Risks

- Permission rejection from app stores
- Users disabling tracking
- Over-notification leading to annoyance

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14. Mitigation Strategy

- Clear permission explanations
- Minimal and meaningful notifications
- User control over settings
- Gradual feature rollout

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15. Definition of Success

ScrollControl is successful if:

- Users become more aware of their screen habits
- Users reduce unnecessary scrolling
- The app becomes part of users' daily routine
